

Vicens Vila-Coury

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Education

Columbia University

New York, NY

PhD Candidate; Department of Ecology, Evolution, and Environmental Biology

Aug. 2022 – Present

- Advisors: Brian T. Smith, Andrés Bendesky
- Committee: Brian T. Smith, Andrés Bendesky, Kira Delmore, Peter Andolfatto, Leonardo Campagna

Cornell University

Ithaca, NY

BA; Department of Biological Sciences, Biodiversity and Systematics concentration

Aug. 2018 – May 2022

- *cum laude* and *with Honors*
- Advisors: Jennifer Walsh-Emond, Irby Lovette, Alejandra Gandolfo

Peer-reviewed Publications

1. Jennifer Walsh, Shawn M. Billerman, Bronwyn G. Butcher, Vanya G. Rohwer, David P. L. Toews, Vicens Vila-Coury, and Irby J. Lovette. A complex genomic architecture underlies reproductive isolation in a North American oriole hybrid zone. *Communications Biology*, 6(1):154, February 2023

Fellowships, Grants, & Awards

RGGS Maxwell/Hanrahan Award, American Museum of Natural History (\$2,500)	2024
Student Research Grant, American Ornithological Society (\$2,000)	2024
L.J. Gormezano Memorial Fund, Dept. of Ornithology, American Museum of Natural History (\$3,000)	2024
Early Systematist Award, Society of Systematic Biologists (\$1,000)	2024
Graduate Student Research Award, Society of Systematic Biologists (\$3,000)	2023
Graduate Research Fellowship, National Science Foundation (>\$100,000)	2022-Present
Graduate Fellow, Richard Gilder Graduate School, American Museum of Natural History	2022-Present
Best in Life Sciences Category, Cornell Undergraduate Research Board Spring Symposium	2022
Kathleen E. Melkonian Fund, Cornell Lab of Ornithology (\$5,000)	2021
Biology Honors Program, Cornell University	2021
Experiential Learning Grant, Cornell Lab of Ornithology (\$5,000)	2021
Experiential Learning Grant, Cornell Lab of Ornithology (\$5,000)	2020
K. Rupert and J. Foote Fund, Cornell Lab of Ornithology (\$1,400)	2019
Redheads Undergraduate Research Grant, Cornell Lab of Ornithology (\$350)	2019

Presentations (*=invited speaker)

Trait Polymorphisms in Birds, Amherst, Massachusetts (symposium talk*)	August 2026
Population, Evolution, and Quantitative Genetics Conference, Pacific Grove, California (poster)	June 2026
The Future of Natural History Collections, Baton Rouge, Louisiana, (panelist*)	January 2026
Society of Systematic Biologists Stand-Alone Meeting, Baton Rouge, Louisiana (talk)	January 2026
AOS Annual Meeting, St. Louis, Missouri (poster)	August 2025
Evolution 2025, Athens, Georgia (poster)	June 2025
Polymorphic Bananaquits: Hyper local adaptation?, St. George's University (lecture*)	March 2024
Society of Systematic Biologists Stand-Alone Meeting, Mexico City, Mexico (poster)	January 2023
Cornell Undergraduate Research Board Spring Symposium, Cornell University (poster)	May 2022
AOS Annual Meeting, virtual meeting (poster)	August 2021

Museum Expeditions (*=specimens collected, †=expedition lead)

Grenada*†	March-April 2026
Saint Vincent†	March 2026
Grenada*†	March-April 2025
Grenada†	March 2024
Tehuacán, Puebla, Mexico*	January 2023
Schuyler County, New York, USA*	July 2019
Tompkins County, New York, USA*	June 2019
Adirondacks, New York, USA*	June 2019
Brewester County, Texas, USA*	April 2019

Teaching Experience

TA: Ornithology (EEEEB 4140), Instructors: Chad Seewagen & Chris Nagy	Fall 2024
TA: Intermediate Statistics for Ecology and Evo. Bio. (EEEEB 4105), Instructor: Steffen Foerster	Spring 2024
“Evolution across space” in Fundamentals of Evolution (EEEEB 6110) (guest lecturer)	Fall 2023
TA: Fundamentals of Evolution (EEEEB 6110), Instructors: Deren Eaton & Daniel Hooper	Fall 2023
TA: Intro to Data Science (INFO 2950), Instructor: Matthew Wilkens	Fall 2021

Selected Service Experience

Science Research Mentorship Program, American Museum of Natural History (mentor)	2026-Present
Evo Supergroup, Columbia University (student organizer)	2023-Present
Evo-Devo Joint Symposium, AMNH & Mount Sinai School of Medicine (co-organizer)	2025
E3B Graduate Student Council, Columbia University (PhD Student Representative)	Fall 2024-Spring 2025
Student Workers of Columbia, Columbia University (E3B Department representative)	Fall 2023-Spring 2024
Undergraduate Outreach Birding Event, E3B Department, Columbia University (volunteer)	2023
Guest Judge, 8th Grade Science Presentations, Hunter’s Point Community Middle School (volunteer)	2023
Resume and CV-writing Workshop, E3B Department, Columbia University (volunteer)	2023
Frontiers of Science Outreach, E3B Department, Columbia University (presentation)	2023
Birding Club at Cornell (president)	2020 - 2021

Other Published Works

2. Vicens Vila-Coury. Ornithological literature: Habitats of north america: A field guide for birders, naturalists, and ecologists. *The Wilson Journal of Ornithology*, 2026
1. Vicens Vila-Coury. Ornithological literature: Better living through birding: Notes from a black man in the natural world. *The Wilson Journal of Ornithology*, 136(2):290–291, June 2024

Selected Workshops & Trainings

SLiM Workshop, American Museum of Natural History, New York, NY	2024
Workshop on Molecular Evolution, Marine Biological Laboratory, Woods Hole, MA	2024
EEB Scholar Finalist (mentor: Rosalyn Price-Waldman), Princeton University	2021

Pre-Doctoral Research Experience

Phylogenomic and demographic history of Song Sparrows, Lovette Lab, Cornell University	2021-2022
Maps Assistant, Birds of the World, Cornell Lab of Ornithology	2020-2022
Historical DNA methods development, Lovette Lab, Cornell University	2019-2022
Ornithology Collections Assistant, Cornell University Museum of Vertebrates, Cornell University	2019

Relevant Coursework

Probabilistic Modeling and Machine Learning (STCS 6701), Instructor: David Blei	Fall 2023
Fundamentals of Evolution (EEEEB 6110), Instructor: Deren Eaton	Fall 2022
Making Sense of Heritable Variation (BIOL 6560), Instructors: Peter Andolfatto & Guy Sella	Fall 2022
Model-Based Phylogenetics (ENTOM 4610), Instructor: Corrie Moreau	Spring 2022
Population Genetics (BIOMG 4810), Instructor: Philipp Messer	Spring 2022
Advanced Genetics and Genomics (BIOMG 3800), Instructor: Thomas Fox	Spring 2021
Evolutionary Genomics (BIOEE 4940), Instructor: Andrew Moeller	Fall 2020
Molecular Systematics (PLBIO 4470), Instructor: Jeffrey Doyle	Spring 2020